itself. Tsunami, a Japanese term, is the name given to the huge waves caused in the sea by an earthquake. Tsunamis are quite common along the coasts of Japan and other regions in the Pacific Ocean.

DO YOU KNOW?

On 26th December 2004, Tsunami in the Indian Ocean swept coastal area of Indonesia, India, Srilanka, Thailand etc., They caused immense damage to life and property in the coastal area

Distribution of Earthquakes

The world's distribution of earthquakes coincide very closely with that of volcanoes. Regions of greatest seismicity are circum-Pacific areas, with the epicenters and the most frequent occurrences along the Pacific Ring of Fire. It is said that about 68 % of earthquakes occur in this belt. Remaining 31 % of earthquakes take place in the Mediterranean-Himalayan belt including Asia Minor, the Himalayas and parts of north-west China. The remaining percent of earthquakes occur in Northen Africa and Rift valley areas of the Red sea and Dead sea.

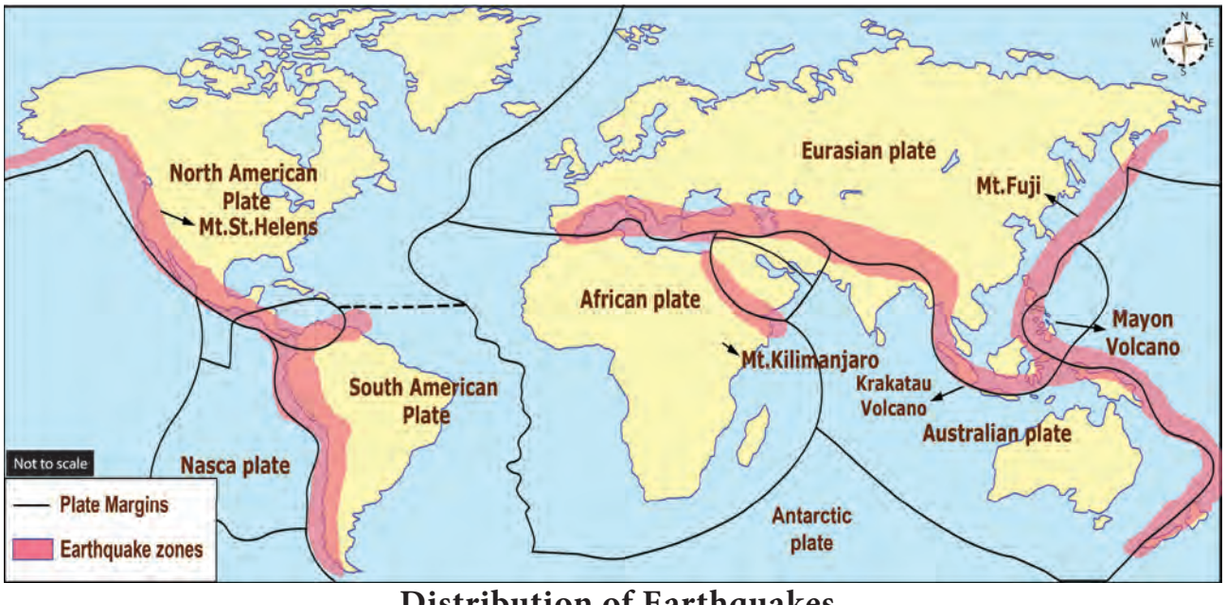
In India, the Himalayan region and the Ganga-Brahamaputra valley are prone to earthquakes. A number of earthquakes have been experienced in this region. Some of them were very severe and caused extensive damage, e.g., the earthquake of Uttar Kashi in 1991 and Chamoli in 1999. The Deccan Plateau, which was supposed to be comparatively free from the dangers of the earthquakes, has experienced two severe earthquakes in the past, the Koyna (Maharashtra) earthquake in 1967 and the Latur earthquake in 1993.

Volcanoes

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A volcano is a vent or an opening in the earth's crust through which hot magma erupts from deep below the surface. The opening is usually circular in form. Volcanic eruptions may also take place through a long crack or fissure through which steam and other materials flow out.

The molten rock material within the earth, together with gases, is called magma. After it rises to the surface, it is called as lava.



Distribution of Earthquakes

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